

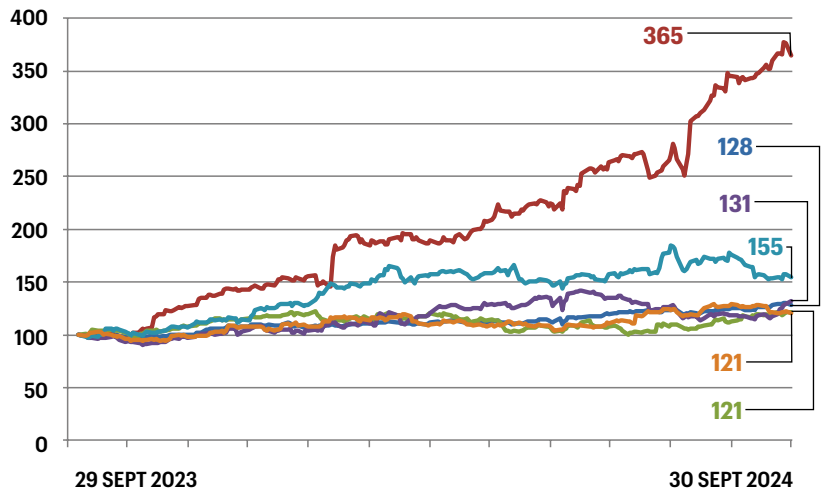


“Today’s portfolio was built with new products to enhance the addressable market, make smart interventions, and refresh designs and features”

P.B. BALAJI
GROUP CFO, TATA MOTORS

AGAINST THE BENCHMARK

➤ Among Tata group companies, Trent performed the best ➤ Tata Motors and Tata Steel also beat the BSE Sensex among the Top 5 group firms



— BSE SENSEX — TRENT — TITAN COMPANY — TATA STEEL
— TATA MOTORS — TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES

SOURCE: ACE EQUITY

consciously ensuring that its companies are also in tune with these changes. A key development for the conglomerate after the demise of Ratan Tata has been the elevation of Trent’s boss Noel Tata as Chairman of Tata Trusts, who has also moved into the board of Tata Sons, the group’s holding company.

This year’s BT500 list of India’s Most Valuable Companies on the basis of market capitalisation has 16 firms from the Tata group. Apart from the biggies like TCS, Tata Steel, Tata Motors, Tata Power, Titan Company, and Indian Hotels, some of the other names are Tata Chemicals, Trent (a company that grew under Noel Tata and is an outperformer on the bourses), Tata Consumer Products, Tata Chemi-

cals, Tata Elxsi, a key player in design and tech services, and Voltas.

Historically, companies in the group have seen high investor interest. That was also visible last November, when Tata Technologies’ initial public offering (IPO) was launched, the first from the group in almost two decades. It received 69 times more bids than the shares on offer. A potential listing of Air India that the Tatas bought back for ₹18,000 crore from the government could well see even more enthusiasm again.

TREADMILL OF CHANGE

From its listing in 2004, TCS has delivered on financial performance and shareholder returns. At an average market capitalisation of over

₹14 lakh crore between October 2023 and September 2024, it is the second most valuable company on the BT500 list of India’s Most Valuable Companies after Reliance Industries.

“If you look at our history, the mantra has always been growth with profitability. Our secret sauce is tight operational control leading to industry-leading margins,” says Samir Seksaria, Chief Financial Officer, TCS. In a world where disruption is the norm, the company’s approach is about “being ahead of the curve” by offering new service lines to get better pricing in the medium to long term. That is coupled with making investments early.

Citing the case of TCS’ deal to upgrade BSNL’s infrastructure,